

London's Royal Parks & Hidden Green Spaces

8 Parks & Secret Spots · All Free · Central London

London has 3,000 parks. The Royal Parks are famous but each one hides spots that even locals don't know. This guide takes you to the exact spots — the views, the cafés, the wildlife — that make each park extraordinary.

YOU SAVE: £150 vs guided tours

■ WHAT THIS GUIDE SAVES YOU

Retail price of this guide
£9.99

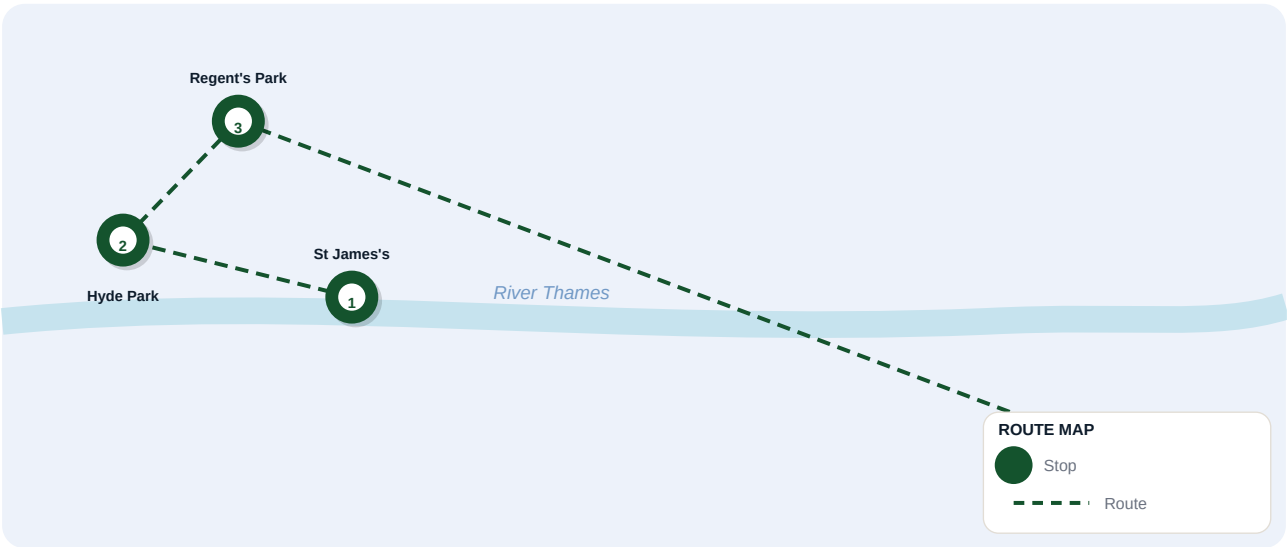
Equivalent guided tours
£160

YOUR SAVING
£150

ROUTE INFO

■ Start	St James's Park — Pelican Rock (Westminster)
■ End	Greenwich Park — Observatory Hilltop (Greenwich)
■ Duration	All Free
■ Transport	From central London: Zone 1–2 daily cap £8.10 covers all stops
■ Total Cost	Guide: £9.99 · Most stops FREE · See individual stop costs

SCHEMATIC ROUTE MAP



PRO TIPS — READ BEFORE YOU GO

■ Best day	Tuesday–Thursday for fewer crowds at almost every location
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■ Saving	Pre-book anything with tickets — usually £2–4 discount per person
■ Offline map	Download Google Maps offline before leaving your hotel
■ Transport	Use Contactless card — automatic daily cap (Zone 1: £8.10, Zone 1-2: £10.10)
■ Members only	This guide is exclusive to London Lens lifetime subscribers

■ COMPLETE STOP GUIDE — LONDON'S ROYAL PARKS & HIDDEN GREEN SPACES

Follow stops 1→4 in order for the best walking route. Each card includes insider tips, savings info, and the cheapest transport option.

1

St James's Park — Pelican Rock

Westminster · Daily 5am–midnight

■ START HERE

HIDDEN TIP

The pelicans in St James's Park have been here since 1664 — a gift from the Russian Ambassador. They're fed at 2:30pm daily, 15 metres from the footpath. Most tourists photograph the palace view; the real hidden gem is the pelican feeding and the bridge's view of Buckingham Palace.

■ **SAVING**

Admission: free (royal park). Guided tour of the park: £15. Free with this guide.

■ **CHEAPEST TRANSPORT**

St James's Park (2 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Pelican feeding at 2:30pm daily (near Duck Island)
- ✓ The bridge: best free view of Buckingham Palace
- ✓ Duck Island Cottage (1840) — find the secret garden gate
- Best: 2:30pm for pelican feeding · Sunset for palace view

AVOID:

Summer weekends — people everywhere

★★★★★

Free

2

Hyde Park — The Serpentine Speal

Hyde Park · Daily 5am–midnight

■ 20 min walk or tube

HIDDEN TIP

Speakers' Corner (Sunday mornings) is extraordinary — anyone can say anything, and the debates get fierce. The Serpentine Gallery (free) has major contemporary art. Few people know the Lido restaurant deck gives free views of the lake without eating.

■ **SAVING**

Free entry. Guided London walks charge £15. Saving: £15

■ **CHEAPEST TRANSPORT**

Marble Arch or Hyde Park Corner (5 min)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Speakers' Corner Sunday 10am: genuinely unmissable
- ✓ Serpentine Gallery — free contemporary art
- ✓ The Italian Water Gardens (north end) — hidden gem
- Best: Sunday 10am–1pm for Speakers' Corner

AVOID:

Avoid the cycle path on foot

★★★★★

Free

3



Regent's Park — Inner Circle Secret Garden

■ 25 min or tube

Regent's Park · Daily 5am–dusk

HIDDEN TIP

Inside Regent's Park is the Inner Circle, and inside that is Queen Mary's Rose Garden — 12,000 rose bushes and almost entirely deserted during the week. Bloom peaks in June. The Open Air Theatre is inside this garden (evening performances).

■ SAVING

Open Air Theatre tickets: £25–45. Garden entry: free. Saving for garden visit: free

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Baker Street or Regent's Park (8 min)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Queen Mary's Rose Garden — free and extraordinary in June
 - ✓ Open Air Theatre (evening — ticketed but magical)
 - ✓ Heron rookery on the boating lake (free)
- Best: June for 12,000 roses in bloom

AVOID:

Arriving by car

★★★★★

Free

4



Greenwich Park — Observatory Hill

■ DLR + walk

Greenwich · Park: Daily 6am–dusk

HIDDEN TIP

The hilltop view from the Royal Observatory is the finest panoramic view of London for free — you don't pay to stand on the hill, only to enter the Observatory building. The view takes in Canary Wharf, the City and the river. At sunset it's extraordinary.

■ SAVING

The View from the Shard costs £33 for a similar panorama. This is free. Saving:

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Cutty Sark DLR (15 min walk uphill) or
Cost: Zone 2 — ~£3 from central London on a single

DO THIS:

- ✓ Free hilltop view (no ticket needed)
 - ✓ Stand on the Prime Meridian line — the brass strip in the path (f...
 - ✓ Cutty Sark nearby — book online for £2 discount
- Best: Clear day late afternoon for the city skyline

AVOID:

Foggy days — the view is the point

★★★★★

Free park · £16 Observatory

QUICK REFERENCE CARD — CUT OUT OR SCREENSHOT

Summary of all stops for easy on-the-go reference.

#	Name	Area	Walk	Cost	Tube	Rating
1	St James's Park — Peli...	Westminster	Start here	Free	St James's Park (2	★★★★★
2	Hyde Park — The Serpen...	Hyde Park	20 min walk or	Free	Marble Arch or Hyd	★★★★★
3	Regent's Park — Inner ...	Regent's Park	25 min or tube	Free	Baker Street or Re	★★★★★
4	Greenwich Park — Obser...	Greenwich	DLR + walk	Free park	Cutty Sark DLR (15	★★★★★

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